

Sunday, 5 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

21° 16°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

16° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Force bosses are set to face MPs over a maternity scandal, as former health secretary Wes Streeting calls out their 'cowardice'.**

Mr Streeting says the refusal of leaders to cooperate is 'an insult' following a BBC investigation. It highlighted a culture of fear and silence surrounding poor care.

HEALTH · UK

- Mini-marts linked to a convicted people smuggler have been closed down after a BBC investigation.**

Twana Jamal, once known as 'the godfather' of French migrant camps, was tracked to two shops in Leicestershire. He was found to be living in the UK and working illegally while seeking asylum.

CRIME · UK

- Tragedy on the roads as one man has died and two others were injured in a crash involving a coach and a van.**

The van driver sadly died at the scene. The coach driver and a 14-year-old passenger were both taken to hospital following the collision.

ACCIDENT · UK

- A second murder arrest has been made in connection with the disappearance of a teenager in 1998.**

A 62-year-old man is being questioned on suspicion of murdering Donna Keogh. She was last seen more than two decades ago.

CRIME · UK

- A financial adviser has admitted conning his friends and neighbours out of a staggering two million pounds.**

Timothy Barnes defrauded dozens of individuals, a charitable trust, and even a residents' association. The full extent of his deception has now been revealed.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 It's official! Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce have tied the knot in a star-studded New York ceremony.**
The couple exchanged vows on Friday after months of speculation. Reports say Adam Sandler officiated, and Taylor wore a Dior dress.
ON AIR – What's your favourite celebrity wedding story?
CELEBRITY · NOW
- 2 Prince William has been chatting all things World Cup football, even revealing his dad 'hates football'!**
The Prince of Wales shared his hopes for England's chances in the tournament on Travis Kelce's podcast. It sounds like he's caught the football fever!
ON AIR – Do you think the Royal Family should talk more about sport?
ROYAL · NOW
- 3 Oasis's 'Wonderwall' has become England's unofficial World Cup anthem, with fans and players singing it post-victory.**
It's become a new tradition this summer, with joyous singalongs after every win. The iconic track seems to perfectly capture the mood of the nation.
ON AIR – What song always gets you in the mood for a big sporting event?
MUSIC · NOW
- 4 A new Reggae Walk of Fame has been launched in Harlesden, celebrating the area's rich musical heritage.**
The trail honours Harlesden's reggae pioneers and Windrush generation. It's a fantastic way to recognise their cultural impact.
ON AIR – What other musical genres deserve their own walk of fame?
CULTURE · NOW
- 5 KSI has addressed his fellow Sidemen, telling them 'I'll always be here' after quitting the YouTube group.**
The social media star shocked fans with his departure over the weekend. Many are now wondering what's next for him and the remaining Sidemen.
ON AIR – Do you think YouTube groups can last forever, or is it natural for members to move on?
SOCIAL MEDIA · NOW

On the schedule

1

England's World Cup last-16 tie against Mexico will kick off at 1am BST on Monday, despite earlier confusion and a FIFA U-turn.

The match will go ahead as scheduled, following a chaotic day on Friday where the kick-off time was uncertain for several hours. Fans will be setting their alarms!

ON AIR – Are you staying up for the 1am kick-off, or will you catch the highlights?

FOOTBALL · UK

2

Wimbledon has seen some major upsets, with top seeds Iga Swiatek and Elena Rybakina both crashing out!

Rybakina, the highest seed to fall so far, lost in straight sets to Elise Mertens. This opens up the women's draw significantly, with Aryna Sabalenka now looking like a strong contender.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for the women's title now that some of the big names are out?

TENNIS · UK

3

Wales kicked off their Nations Championship campaign with a strong performance, beating Fiji 39-24.

The Welsh side scored six tries in their opener at the Cardiff City stadium. It's a great start for them in the inaugural competition.

ON AIR – How important is it for Wales to start strong in a new tournament like this?

RUGBY · UK

4

India's 15-year-old sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi made a spectacular ODI debut, smashing huge sixes off Jofra Archer and Josh Tongue.

The young cricketer showed no nerves, quickly making an impact in India's innings against England at Old Trafford. He's definitely one to watch!

ON AIR – At what age do you think sports stars are ready for the big stage?

CRICKET · UK

5

British Red Bull Junior driver Fionn McLaughlin has scored his first Formula 3 points, finishing ninth at Silverstone.

It's a fantastic achievement for the young driver, securing points in the sprint race at his home Grand Prix. A promising sign for the future!

ON AIR – How exciting is it to see new British talent emerging in motorsport?

F1 · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that the simple act of looking at clouds can significantly reduce stress.**
Participants reported feeling calmer and more mindful after just ten minutes of cloud-gazing, highlighting nature's quiet power.
- 2 The surprising charm of 'vintage board games' is seeing a major resurgence among families and friends.**
It seems people are reconnecting with the joy of unplugged fun, opting for classic physical games over digital entertainment.
- 3 Research indicates that 'taking a short, brisk walk' in a green space can boost your creativity by up to 60%.**
A change of scenery and a bit of fresh air are proving to be powerful catalysts for new ideas and problem-solving.
- 4 The nostalgic appeal of 'classic radio plays' is making a comeback, with many listeners seeking out audio drama for entertainment.**
This return to storytelling without visuals offers a wonderful escape and sparks the imagination in a unique way.
- 5 A quirky new poll suggests that over half of Britons admit to 'talking to their plants'.**
Whether it's encouragement or a friendly chat, many believe their green companions appreciate the vocal attention.
- 6 Scientists have discovered that 'trees in a forest can communicate' with each other through an underground network of fungi.**
This fascinating 'wood-wide web' allows trees to share nutrients and send warning signals about pests or diseases.
- 7 The unexpected joy of 'stargazing in your own garden' is becoming a popular evening activity.**
With clear skies and a comfortable spot, many are finding a new appreciation for the wonders of the night sky without leaving home.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with the remote control when we can't find it, even though we know it doesn't help?

ANSWER: WAVING OUR HANDS VAGUELY IN THE AIR, HOPING IT'LL MAGICALLY APPEAR FROM UNDER A CUSHION!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'song' they absolutely have to sing along to, no matter where they are or who's listening?

ANSWER: THAT ONE CLASSIC TUNE THAT JUST GETS YOU EVERY TIME, EVEN IF YOU DON'T KNOW ALL THE WORDS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem of a local shop' you've never noticed before, and it becomes your new favourite?

What's the best unexpected discovery you've made in your local area recently?

- We all have those 'little habits' that we do every morning to start the day just right, don't we?

What's your essential morning ritual that sets you up for a good day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the chameleon changes colour to blend in with its surroundings, but also to express its mood?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the only living thing on Earth visible from space.
- A 'byte' of computer memory is made up of 8 bits.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion of the iron.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- The world's smallest continent is Australia.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water – this is known as the Mpemba effect.

On this day

Day 186 of the year, 179 days left in 2026. Today Bloody Thursday (International Longshore and Warehouse Union); Christian feast day: Anthony Maria Zaccaria, priest (died 1539); Christian feast day: Cyril and Methodius (a public holiday in Czech Republic and Slovakia); Christian feast day: Martha, mother of Simeon Stylites the Younger. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1929 — Katherine Helmond, American actress and director (died 2019)
- 1991 — Jason Dolley, American actor, musician and Twitch streamer
- 1982 — Dave Haywood, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1929 — Tony Lock, English cricketer (died 1995)
- 1963 — Edie Falco, American actress
- 1979 — Shane Filan, Irish singer-songwriter
- 1938 — Ronnie Self, American singer-songwriter (died 1981)
- 1964 — Ronald D. Moore, American screenwriter and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1984 — The United States Supreme Court gives its *United States v. Leon* decision providing a good-faith exception from the Fourth Amendment exclusionary rule against use of evidence obtained through defective warrants in criminal trials.
- 1973 — Juvénal Habyarimana seizes power over Rwanda in a coup d'état.
- 2016 — The Juno space probe arrives at Jupiter and begins a 20-month survey of the planet.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — U.S. President Bill Clinton imposes trade and economic sanctions against the Taliban regime in Afghanistan.
- 1989 — Iran–Contra affair: Oliver North is sentenced by U.S. District Judge Gerhard A. Gesell to a three-year suspended prison term, two years probation, \$150,000 in fines and 1,200 hours community service. His convictions are later overturned.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1996 — Dolly the sheep becomes the first mammal cloned from an adult cell.

- 1994 — Jeff Bezos founds Amazon.
- 2006 — North Korea tests four short-range missiles, one medium-range missile and a long-range Taepodong-2. The long-range Taepodong-2 reportedly fails in mid-air over the Sea of Japan.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 187 of the year, 178 days left in 2026. Today The first day of the Festival of San Fermín, which lasts until July 14. (Pamplona); Christian feast day: Goar of Aquitaine; Christian feast day: Maria Goretti; Christian feast day: Blessed Mary Theresa Ledóchowska. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Rory Delap, English-Irish footballer
- 1940 — Jeannie Seely, Grammy Award-winning country music singer-songwriter and Grand Ole Opry member (died 2025)
- 1939 — Mary Peters, English-Irish pentathlete and shot putter
- 1949 — Phyllis Hyman, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1995)
- 1970 — Inspectah Deck, American rapper and producer
- 1982 — Misty Upham, American actress (died 2014)
- 1998 — Comethazine, American rapper
- 1939 — Jet Harris, English bass player (died 2011)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 1975 — The Comoros declares independence from France.
- 1957 — Althea Gibson wins at the Wimbledon Championships, becoming the first black athlete to do so.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1966 — Malawi becomes a republic, with Hastings Banda as its first President.
- 2006 — The Nathu La pass between India and China, sealed during the Sino-Indian War, re-opens for trade after 44 years.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)